

PROJECT BOATY

Subsystem Specification

Mission computer

Take and geotag photos, relay MAVLink to the bank, and run the small boat-side watchdogs, without ever being needed for safety.

Document	BOATY-SSS-MCP
Issue	Issue A (for review)
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Status	For review by the project owner
Parents	SRS Issue D, ADD Issue C, ICD Issue B
Content	12 allocated SRS requirements → 21 subsystem requirements (13 M, 6 S, 2 C)

Document control

Issue	Date	Change	By
A	28 September 2026	First issue, for review.	Claude (drafted)

Role	Name	Signature / date
Author	Claude, for Project Boaty	
Reviewer / approver	Project owner	

Review guidance: section 5 is what will be built and tested. Check that each requirement is right, sufficient and testable. Section 4 shows every parent requirement is covered (the build script checks this).

Contents

1. Scope	3
1.1 Purpose	3
1.2 Boundary	3
1.3 Breakdown	3
2. Applicable documents	3
3. Interfaces	3
4. Parent requirements	4
5. Subsystem requirements	5
5.1 Hardware	5
5.2 Platform software	5
5.3 Camera and photos (B2, B3)	5
5.4 Weed-shedding and command filter (B5)	5
5.5 Future: on-board duck spotting	6
6. Timing	7
7. Design constraints and budgets	7
8. Verification and open items	7

1. Scope

1.1 Purpose

Take and geotag photos, relay MAVLink to the bank, and run the small boat-side watchdogs, without ever being needed for safety.

1.2 Boundary

Inside this subsystem	Outside (and who owns it)
• Raspberry Pi Zero 2W, microSD, heatsink • 5 MP camera • Moisture sensor • OS image and services B1-B6	• Its 5 V supply (PWR) • Camera hood and mount (HUL) • Helm behaviour (HLM)

1.3 Breakdown

Item	Description
MCP-1 Computer	Pi Zero 2W, 32 GB A1/U3 microSD, heatsink
MCP-2 Camera	OV5647-class 5 MP, $\leq 62^\circ$ HFOV
MCP-3 Sensors	Moisture traces at the box low point
MCP-4 Software	B1 router, B2 camera, B3 photo server, B4 link watchdog, B5 weed-shedding, B6 health

2. Applicable documents

Document	Use
BOATY-SRS-001 Issue D	Parent requirements
BOATY-ADD-001 Issue C	Allocation, decisions, budgets, early verification items
BOATY-ICD-001 Issue B	Interface definitions (all listed in section 3 apply in full)

3. Interfaces

The subsystem shall meet every interface below as defined in the ICD. 'Owner' means this subsystem maintains the definition.

Interface	Other end	Role	ICD
IF-01 Boat-bank radio link	Mission Control	Conforms	\$4
IF-03 Photo & health service	Mission Control	Owner	\$4
IF-04 Companion link	Helm	Owner	\$4
IF-08 Mission computer power	Power	Conforms	\$6

4. Parent requirements

Primary (12): this subsystem is responsible for meeting and verifying these SRS requirements.

SRS	Pri	Requirement (abridged)	Met by
FS-006	S	Weed-shedding: after a stuck detection the boat shall try up to 3 short reverse bursts, then resume its previous mode...	MCP-D18
FS-010	S	Water ingress: a moisture sensor in the electronics box shall trigger RTL and an alarm.	MCP-D03, MCP-D15
CAM-001	M	The boat shall carry a forward-looking camera that captures still images of at least 2 MP (M) and at least 5 MP (S).	MCP-D01
CAM-002	M	Capture modes shall be: interval (every 2 to 30 s), at photo points, and on command.	MCP-D10
CAM-003	M	Every photo shall be tagged with UTC time, position, heading and mission ID.	MCP-D11
CAM-004	M	Local storage shall hold at least 500 photos. Full storage shall not affect navigation or safety.	MCP-D06, MCP-D13
CAM-005	S	A duck (about 0.3 m long) at 5 m shall span at least 40 pixels in the image.	MCP-D02
CAM-007	S	After a mission, photos shall transfer to Mission Control automatically when in range, with 200 photos taking 5 min or...	MCP-D14, MCP-D16
CAM-008	C	Mission Control may show a low-rate live view from the camera.	MCP-D17
DET-003	C	An upgraded mission computer may detect waterfowl on board in real time and trigger 'pause and look' (hold and take a...	MCP-D20
DET-004	M	If DET-003 is implemented, 'pause and look' shall hold position and shall never steer towards the detected animal.	MCP-D21
PWR-010	M	Electronics in the sealed box shall run for 60 min at 30 °C ambient in direct sun without fault or throttling.	MCP-D04

Supporting (14): another subsystem owns these, but this subsystem must provide something for them. Where relevant, section 5 includes the contribution.

PRE-008, FS-003, FS-007, CAM-006, COM-001, COM-002, COM-003, COM-004, COM-006, PWR-005, SWE-004, SWE-008, LOG-004, ENV-005

5. Subsystem requirements

Requirements are numbered MCP-Dnn. Pri, Ver and Stage follow SRS conventions (M/S/C; Test, Demonstration, Inspection, Analysis, Simulation; SIM, BENCH, POOL, LAKE). 'Trace' lists the parent SRS requirements, interfaces (IF), decisions (DD) and early verification items (V) it implements.

5.1 Hardware

ID	Requirement	Pri	Ver	Stage	Trace
MCP-D01	The mission computer shall be a Pi Zero 2W with a 32 GB A1/U3 microSD and a 5 MP camera.	M	I	BENCH	CAM-001, DD-03
MCP-D02	Camera horizontal field of view shall be $\leq 62^\circ$, giving ≥ 120 px across a 0.3 m duck at 5 m (at 2592 px width).	S	A	BENCH	CAM-005
MCP-D03	A moisture sensor (exposed traces at the box's lowest point) shall be read by GPIO.	S	T	BENCH	FS-010
MCP-D04	The SoC shall have a heatsink, and 60 min at 30 °C in the sealed box in sun shall give no throttling (throttled flag = 0).	M	T	BENCH	PWR-010, V-10
MCP-D05	Average power ≤ 2.0 W, peak ≤ 3.0 W.	S	T	BENCH	PWR-011

5.2 Platform software

ID	Requirement	Pri	Ver	Stage	Trace
MCP-D06	The OS shall be Raspberry Pi OS Lite 64-bit with a read-only root filesystem and a separate data partition.	M	T	BENCH	CAM-004, IF-08
MCP-D07	Services B1-B6 shall be systemd units that restart automatically and are running ≤ 45 s after power-on.	M	T	BENCH	IF-04, IF-03
MCP-D08	The clock shall be set from helm GNSS time at start (no internet on the boat).	S	T	BENCH	SWE-008
MCP-D09	SSH shall be key-only, and the firewall per IF-01.	M	I	BENCH	COM-006, IF-01

5.3 Camera and photos (B2, B3)

ID	Requirement	Pri	Ver	Stage	Trace
MCP-D10	B2 shall capture on interval (2-30 s during AUTO), at photo points (burst_n within 0.5 s of arrival) and on command.	M	T	SIM	CAM-002, IF-03
MCP-D11	Each photo shall carry UTC time, lat/lon/heading (≤ 0.5 s old, else null) and mission ID, in EXIF and the index.	M	T	SIM	CAM-003
MCP-D12	B4 (link watchdog): in AUTO with no system-255 heartbeat for 60 s $\rightarrow$ RTL. In HOLD after a MANUAL link loss, at 10 s $\rightarrow$ RTL.	M	S	SIM	FS-003, FS-002
MCP-D13	≥ 5 GB shall be reserved for photos (≥ 500 at ≤ 2.5 MB). Capture stops below 500 MB free. Navigation is unaffected.	M	T	BENCH	CAM-004
MCP-D14	B3 shall implement IF-03, with thumbnails made at capture time.	M	T	BENCH	IF-03, CAM-007
MCP-D15	B6 (health): moisture $\rightarrow$ RTL within 2 s plus STATUSTEXT. After a position-loss HOLD, RTL once the EKF has been healthy for 10 s.	M	S	SIM	FS-010, FS-004
MCP-D16	Photo sync throughput ≥ 11 Mbit/s with the boat ≤ 10 m from the bank (200 photos ≤ 5 min).	S	T	POOL	CAM-007
MCP-D17	Optional live view: 320 $\times$ 240 MJPEG at 2 fps when enabled, paused during sync.	C	D	POOL	CAM-008

5.4 Weed-shedding and command filter (B5)

ID	Requirement	Pri	Ver	Stage	Trace
MCP-D18	B5 shall act only on a helm stuck event. Up to 3 GUIDED astern bursts (≤ 0.5 m/s, ≤ 2 s, targets at 10 Hz), then resume the previous mode if ground speed > 0.3 m/s is regained, else HOLD + alarm.	S	S	SIM	FS-006, V-11
MCP-D19	All services shall send MAVLink only through a shared client that blocks forbidden messages (IF-04 list).	M	T	SIM	SAF-003, IF-04

5.5 Future: on-board duck spotting

ID	Requirement	Pri	Ver	Stage	Trace
MCP-D20	An upgrade may run an on-device bird detector at ≥ 2 fps that requests 'pause and look'.	C	T	POOL	DET-003
MCP-D21	'Pause and look' shall only request LOITER (≤ 20 s) and then resume. It shall never steer towards the detection. Applies only if MCP-D20 is implemented.	M	S	SIM	DET-004

6. Timing

Event	Response	Budget
MISSION_ITEM_REACHED (photo point)	First photo of the burst	≤ 0.5 s
Interval tick	Photo captured	± 0.2 s
Moisture detected	RTL requested	≤ 2 s
No system-255 heartbeat in AUTO	RTL requested	$60 \text{ s} \pm 1 \text{ s}$
Helm stuck event	First astern burst	≤ 1 s
Power-on	All services running	≤ 45 s
POST /v1/shutdown	Filesystems synced, halt	≤ 10 s

7. Design constraints and budgets

- ADD DD-03 / T4: Pi Zero 2W (Python)
- ADD section 4.3 rule: may request only safer states; B5 bounded GUIDED
- SWE-001: Python services

Budget	Allocation
Mass allocation	≤ 35 g (estimate 30 g)
Cost allocation	£27 (Pi £15, camera £8, SD £4)
Power	≤ 2.0 W average, ≤ 3.0 W peak

8. Verification and open items

Each requirement is verified at its stage using the method shown. Test procedures are written per stage and reference these IDs.

Stage	Test	Demo	Inspect	Analysis	Sim	Reqs
SIM	3	-	-	-	4	7
BENCH	8	-	2	1	-	11
POOL	2	1	-	-	-	3
LAKE	-	-	-	-	-	0

Ref	Open item
V-10	Thermal in the sealed box
V-11	Helm stops if B5 dies mid-burst